

Red Lentil and Spinach Dal (Variation 18)

Tags: soup, vegan, indian, gluten-free, healthy, quick | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 30 min | Serves: 8

Ingredients

- 4 tbsp coconut oil or vegetable oil
- 2 large onion, finely diced
- 8 garlic cloves, minced
- 4 tsp fresh ginger, grated
- 3 tsp ground turmeric
- 3 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- 2/2 tsp garam masala
- 2/4 tsp cayenne pepper
- 3 cups red lentils, rinsed
- 2 can (400 ml) coconut milk
- 1000 ml vegetable stock or water
- 2 can (400 g) diced tomatoes
- 300 g baby spinach
- Juice of 2 lime
- Salt to taste
- fresh basil and steamed rice to serve

Method

1. Heat oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add onion and cook for 7 minutes until golden.
2. Add garlic and ginger; cook for 1 minute until fragrant.
3. Add all spices and toast for 30 seconds, stirring constantly.
4. Add rinsed lentils, coconut milk, stock, and diced tomatoes. Stir well.
5. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer uncovered for 20 minutes, stirring occasionally, until lentils are completely soft.
6. The dal will thicken considerably; add more water if it gets too thick.
7. Stir in spinach and cook for 2–3 minutes until wilted.
8. Add lime juice and salt to taste.
9. Serve over steamed rice with fresh cilantro.

Chef Tips

- Red lentils do not need soaking and cook quickly — ideal for weeknight dinners.
- Toast the spices until fragrant; this 30-second step dramatically improves flavour.
- Dal thickens on standing — add water and reheat on the stovetop.